UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2016

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **(Exam date : 07.08.2016)** **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. In the context of the history of India, consider the following pairs :

Term		Description
1. Eripatti	:	Land, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of the village
2. Taniyurs	:	Villages donated to a single Brahmin or a group of Brahmins
3. Ghatikas	:	Collages generally attached to the temples

Which of the pairs given above is / are correctly matched ?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 3

Ans. (d): Taniyur is a large village under Chola administrative division.
Eripatti was a special category of land known in South India. This land was donated by individuals, revenue from which was set apart for the maintenance of the village tank. Land grants and generous donations were given to educational intuitions like Ghatikas and Mathas. Mathas were residential schools for early education in Pallava Kingdoms.

2. Which one of the following books of ancient India has the love story of the son of the founder of Sunga dynasty ?

(a) Swapnavasavadatta (b) Malavikagnimitra
(c) Meghadoota (d) Ratnavali

Ans. (b): Malavikagnimitram is a Sanskrit play written by Kalidas in the 5th century CE. It narrates the love story of King Agnimitra, the Sunga emperor of Vidisha. Agnimitra was the son of Pushyamitra Shunga, founder of the Sunga dynasty.

- Kalidas is the most distinguished dramatist and he treated the rasa of love in all its possible manifestations.
- Swapnavasavadatta is a Sanskrit play of six acts written by Bhasa.
- Meghadoota is a Sanskrit poem by Kalidasa.
- Ratnavali is a Sanskrit drama about a princess Ratnavali and a king Udayana written by Harshavardhan.

3. With reference to the cultural history of India the memorizing of chronicles, dynastic histories and epic tales was the profession of who of following?

(a) Shramana (b) Parivraajaka
(c) Agrahaarika (d) Magadha

Ans. (d): Memorizing of chronicles, dynastic hysterics or epic tales was the work of a different groups of people, the Sutas and Magadhas, who were the descendants of the priestly families of the Vedic period.

4. Consider the following pairs :

Famous place	Region
1. Bodhgaya	Baghelkhand
2. Khajuraho	Bundelkhand
3. Shirdi	Vidarbha
4. Nasik (Nashik)	Malwa
5. Tirupati	Rayalaseema

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 2, 3, 4, and 5
(c) 2 and 5 only (d) 1, 3, 4 and 5

Ans. (c) : Bodhgaya is an important Buddhist site located in Bihar and Baghelkhand is a mountain range in central India that covers the northeastern regions of Madhya Pradesh and a small area of western Uttar Pradesh.

- The Khajuraho Group of Monuments is a group of Hindu temples which are located in the Bundelkhand region of the Madhya Pradesh, southeast of Jhansi. It is one of the UNESCO World Heritage sites in India.
- Shirdi, famous town for Sai Baba temple, is a town and falls under the Ahmednagar district in Maharashtra and it is not in the Vidarbha region.
- Malwa Plateau generally refers to the volcanic upland north of the Vindhya Range covering the region in Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, Nasik is for away from the region.
- Tirupati, famous for Sri Venkateswara temple, lies in the Rayalaseema region of Andhra Pradesh.

• Buddha, Jaina, Bhagavata, Shiva and Other Religion

5. With reference to the religious history of India consider the following statements :

1. The concept of Bodhisattva is central to Hinayana sect of Buddhism.
2. Bodhisattva is a compassionate one on his way to enlightenment.
3. Bodhisattva delays achieving his own salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to it

Which of the statements given above is / are correct ?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (b): The Bodhisattva ideal is central to the Mahayana Buddhist tradition as the individual who seeks enlightenment both for himself and few others. In non-Mahayana Buddhism, it usually refers either to Maitreya, the Buddha of the Future or to the historical Buddha, Gautama, prior to his enlightenment.
Statement (2) and (3): A bodhisattva is literally a living (sattva) who aspires to enlightenment (bodhi) and carries out altruistic practices. Clearly, option (2) is correct. Bodhisattva delays achieving his own salvation to help all sentient beings on their path to it.

• Maurya and Post Maurya Period

6. Who of the following had first deciphered the edicts of Emperor Ashoka ?

(a) Georg Buhler (b) James Prinsep
(c) Max Muller (d) William Jones

Ans. (b): It was James Prinsep in 1837 who succeeded in deciphering an ancient inscription on a large stone pillar in Delhi, which was the edict of Emperor Ashoka.

7. What is/are common to the two historical places known as Ajanta and Mahbalipuram ?

1. Both were built in the same period.
2. Both belong to the same religious denomination.
3. Both have rock-cut monuments.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

(a) 1and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) None of the statements given above is correct.

Ans. (b) : The Ajanta caves in Aurangabad district of Maharashtra, are about 30 rock- cut Buddhist cave monuments that date from the 2nd century BCE to about 480 as 650 CE. The caves include paintings and sculptures described by the Governments. Archaeological Survey of India as "the finest surviving examples of Indian art, particularly painting", which are masterpieces of Buddhists religious art with figures of the Buddha and depictions of the Jataka tales.
Mahabalipuram has a group of sanctuaries which was carved out of rock along the coromandel coast in the 7th and 8th centuries rathas (temple is the from of chariots), mandapas (cave sanctuaries), giant open-air rock reliefs such as the famous Descent of Ganges and the shore temple with thousands of sculptures to the glory of Shiva. The group of Monuments at Mahabalipuram has been classified as a UNESCO World Heritage site.

• Political-Social System between 800 AD to 1200 AD

8. Banjaras during the medieval period of Indian history were generally–

(a) Agriculturists (b) Warriors
(c) Weavers (d) Traders

Ans. (d): The Banjaras were the most important trader-nomads. Their canvas was called tanda. Sultan Alauddin Khilji used the Banjaras to transport grain to the city market. Emperor Jahangir wrote in his memoirs that the Banjaras carried grain on their bullocks from different areas and sold it in towns.

MEDIEVAL HISTORY

• Vijayanagara Empire and Bahmanids

9. Regarding the taxation system of Krishna Deva, the ruler of Vijayanagar, consider the following Statements.

1. The tax rate on land was fixed depending on the quality of the land.
2. Private owners of workshops paid an industries tax.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Land revenue was the chief source of income. The land was divided into four categories for the purpose of assessment, wetland, dry land, orchards and woods. Usually the share was one-sixth of the produce. Land revenue could be paid in cash or kind. The rates varied according to the types of the crops, soil method of irrigation, etc. so option (1) is correct.

- Besides land tax, many professional taxes were also imposed. They were imposed on shopkeeper, servants, workmen, posters, shoemakers, musicians, etc. There was also a tax on property. Grazing and house taxes were also imposed; commercial taxes consisted of levied, duties and customs on manufactured articles of trade were also levied. Private owners of workshops paid an industries tax, therefore option (2) is also correct.